

Focussing

Focussing is an integral part of photography irrespective of manual, or automatic digital cameras. A camera focusses by adjusting the distance of the lens from the film or sensor of the camera. Depending on the distance of the other objects and the kind of lens used, the objects around the subject of the photo will appear out of focus and blurred. With digital cameras and also with automated film cameras, focussing is done by the camera itself. These days, all cameras come with auto-focus systems. When you partially press the shutter release, the camera focusses on the target, after which you can proceed to click the photo.

7.1 Focussing modes – Continuous / Single focus

Cameras usually have two modes of focus. They are basically settings that tell the camera when to focus. Focussing in cameras is done when you first press the shutter release half way through but without actually clicking the button.

Cameras should only focus while you click a photo. This is the setting that can be found on your camera under the setup menu of your camera. Turn it on and the camera will only focus when you half press the trigger when you are about to click a photo.

In the continuous focus mode, the camera lens is constantly adjusting itself to focus on the object in front of it. This option can also be enabled under the main setup menu in your camera. Focussing times are cut down a bit. Some cameras use the continuous focus mode as a pre-focus system where the camera partially focuses on the target to cut down focus times when you are about to click the photo. This is useful when you trying to focus on moving targets.

Both focus modes have a few advantages and disadvantages. The continuous mode forces the camera to constantly